

Open Letter to President Brewster

January 25, 1972, the Yale NEWS reported: "The recruitment program remained basically unchanged this year except for an expanded effort to recruit minority group members." Boricuas Unidos takes this opportunity to refute the implication of this article that this recruitment drive represents a sincere ongoing commitment for the recruitment of minority students—specifically, the mainland Puerto Rican. On September 27, 1971, Boricuas Unidos submitted a memorandum on "The Admission of Puerto Rican Students" to Yale's Provost Taylor, Secretary Chauncey, and Director of Admissions Muyskens. We have yet to receive any official reply from these gentlemen. The piecemeal recruitment effort envisioned by Yale College for the recruitment of Puerto Rican students to Yale for next year is presently doomed to failure. We have been led to believe that the Puerto Rican recruitment drive was to be formulated and planned by the Puerto Rican students themselves, but, in point of fact, the recruitment effort has been preplanned and is obstructed by bureaucratic delays. The so-called expanded recruitment effort is tailored to the needs of the admissions office without regard to the needs of the mainland Puerto Rican student.

Specifically, the constraints of time make it impossible for Boricuas Unidos to embark upon any immediate recruitment of students. As of January 31, 1972, no recruitment may be carried out unless five weeks ahead of time, the following information is submitted:

- (1) Names of recruiters
- (2) Date of departure and return
- (3) Names of all schools to be visited, what times, what dates, and which specific counselors will be met
- (4) Money requested for transportation

The purchase of all airline tickets will be done solely by the University; thus further delaying the process of recruitment. In short, this means that no one may recruit during the week of March 14 unless submitting the minority travel schedule by February 7.

Anyone familiar with the process of admission or recruitment, especially in New York City where 56 percent of the Puerto Rican population resides, would know that contacting counselors alone would take a minimum of two weeks. Furthermore, before meeting with any counselor, the principal of the school must be officially informed, thus delaying the process even more.

Additionally, scheduling in public schools in New York City is made difficult because most high schools with Puerto Rican populations run with double shifts. Thus the recruiter in any New York City school must conform to the scheduling and particular situation of the local school. The inflexibility of Yale's requirements for recruitment makes it impossible for us to launch any comprehensive recruitment effort evidencing a continued Yale commitment for the recruitment of Puerto Rican students. It is obvious, given the facts embodied in our memorandum which accompanies this statement, that the lack of an ongoing recruitment effort of Puerto Rican juniors and seniors will mean the nonadmission or nonrepresentation of Puerto Ricans to Yale College. Most important, however, no issue affects recruitment as much as the inflexibility of admissions criteria for Puerto Rican students.

In our most recent recruitment, Puerto Rican applicants have been discouraged from applying solely on the basis of SAT scores. One candidate's counselor was told to discourage a particular Puerto Rican student from applying on the basis of his SAT scores despite the fact that he had a 90 average. While SATs may be an important indicator of academic success for the average Yale applicant, Fred E. Crossland, program officer for special projects in education for the Ford Foundation, indicates in the foundation's report entitled "Minority Access to College" that SATs alone are an unreliable measure of the student's actual potential.

This is particularly true with regard to the Puerto Rican who is both bilingual and bicultural and against whom more often

than not these types of exams discriminate. The lack of any Puerto Rican input, either through representation on the admissions committee or as readers of folders, or as candidate interviewers further obstructs the possibility that any number of Puerto Rican students will be admitted. Accordingly, Boricuas Unidos questions the extent of Yale's commitment to the mainland Puerto Rican student particularly with regard to the following areas:

- (1) The flexibility of admissions criteria which takes into account the bilingual and bicultural background of the Puerto Rican candidate.
 - (2) An ongoing comprehensive program as opposed to the current piecemeal program offered by the Yale admissions office.
 - (3) The immediate hiring of a Puerto Rican as an assistant dean of admissions at an adequate salary specifically in charge of recruitment in New York City.
 - (4) The hiring of Yale Puerto Rican graduate students to read mainland Puerto Rican applications to Yale College.
 - (5) The admission of Puerto Rican mainland students to Yale commensurate with their status as the second largest minority group in the Northeast.
 - (6) An official response from President Brewster regarding the memorandum submitted to Provost Taylor on September 27, 1971.
 - (7) The rejection of the present financial aid policy which prevents any student from taking out a federal loan while having a federally funded work-study job, thus preventing him from working in the New Haven community.
 - (8) The failure of Yale to recruit mainland Puerto Rican high school seniors from Catholic high schools.
 - (9) The referring of any Puerto Rican student coming onto the Yale campus to Boricuas Unidos.
- Until the University is willing to actively support the above stated objectives, Boricuas Unidos withdraws from the Yale Minority Recruitment Committee.

Executive Committee of
Boricuas Unidos
Hector Medina, 1973
Gilbert Casellas, 1974
Eduardo Padro, 1975
Cruz Ramos, 1975
Manuel del Valle y Colon, 1974L